

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Security Engineer | Microsoft Sentinel | KQL | Threat Hunting | Detection Engineering

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Senior Security Engineer with over five years of experience managing and optimising Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) platforms, developing KQL (Kusto Query Language) detection rules and leading proactive threat hunting operations across complex enterprise environments. In my current role at the University of the Arts London (UAL), I manage Microsoft Sentinel across an 8,000-user enterprise environment, configuring data connectors, onboarding critical log sources including Active Directory (AD), firewalls, cloud platforms and servers, and building detection use cases mapped to the MITRE ATT&CK framework. I hold the Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) certification and bring deep hands-on expertise in workbook development, threat hunting, detection playbook refinement and security advisory support for tool evaluations and proof of concepts (POCs), enabling organisations to extract maximum detection and response value from their Microsoft Sentinel investment.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM Management and Optimisation:** Microsoft Sentinel, CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM; data connector configuration, detection rules, workbooks, log source onboarding
- **KQL (Kusto Query Language):** Detection rule development, threat hunting queries, scheduled analytics rules, workbook reporting
- **Log Source Onboarding and Configuration:** Active Directory (AD), firewalls, cloud platforms (Azure, Microsoft 365), servers, endpoint agents
- **Threat Detection and Hunting:** Proactive threat hunting, MITRE ATT&CK-aligned use case development, monitoring control enhancement
- **Detection Playbook Development:** Incident response playbook creation and refinement, SOAR automation integration
- **Incident Response Support:** Alert monitoring, suspicious activity investigation, containment and remediation coordination
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent, Falcon Insight, Falcon Discover; Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE)
- **Identity and Access Management (IAM):** Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Microsoft Entra ID, Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO)
- **Privileged Access Management (PAM):** BeyondTrust
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS)
- **Security Advisory:** Tool evaluations, proof of concept (POC) assessments, security architecture input
- **Scripting:** PowerShell
- **Frameworks:** NIST CSF, CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts London (UAL)

March 2025 - Present

- Manage and optimise Microsoft Sentinel SIEM across an 8,000-user enterprise environment, configuring data connectors, managing detection rules, developing workbooks and maintaining the overall health and effectiveness of the platform
- Develop and fine-tune KQL queries for threat hunting, scheduled analytics rule creation and reporting, improving detection fidelity and reducing false positive alert volumes
- Onboard and configure critical log sources including Active Directory (AD), Check Point Harmony firewalls, Microsoft Azure cloud services, Microsoft 365 and server infrastructure, ensuring comprehensive data ingestion into Microsoft Sentinel

- Build and enhance threat detection use cases and monitoring controls, mapping detection logic to the MITRE ATT&CK framework to ensure coverage across priority threat categories including credential theft, lateral movement, persistence and exfiltration
- Monitor systems for suspicious activity, triaging and investigating alerts to support incident response efforts and drive timely containment and remediation
- Lead proactive threat hunting operations using CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and Microsoft Sentinel, identifying indicators of compromise (IoCs) and advanced persistent threats (APTs) beyond the reach of automated alerting
- Refine and maintain detection playbooks and Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) integrations, continuously improving the efficiency and effectiveness of the security operations function
- Provide security advisory support for tool evaluations and proof-of-concept (POC) assessments, helping stakeholders select and validate security technologies that align with organisational requirements
- Administer BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) and Microsoft Entra ID Conditional Access, enforcing access security controls across enterprise systems
- Drive vulnerability management using Tenable.io, AppCheck and Pentera BAS, translating findings into prioritised remediation actions

University of the Arts, London (UAL) Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

- Managed Microsoft Sentinel SIEM data connector configuration and log source onboarding, supporting the expansion of monitoring coverage across on-premise and cloud infrastructure
- Developed and refined KQL-based detection rules and monitoring controls within Microsoft Sentinel, improving alert fidelity and extending threat visibility across key attack surfaces
- Monitored security alerts for suspicious activity, conducting investigations and supporting incident response efforts in line with documented playbooks and NIST 800-61 procedures
- Contributed to detection playbook development and refinement, documenting investigation workflows and improving the consistency of incident handling
- Supported proactive threat hunting activities, using SIEM and Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) query capabilities to identify threats outside automated detection thresholds
- Assisted with security advisory input for technology evaluations and security tool POCs, contributing technical analysis and recommendations to the security team
- Supported identity security programme including Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) access governance, Conditional Access configuration and privileged access management

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS FinTech) Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

- Delivered security engineering and infrastructure management within a Software as a Service (SaaS) and FinTech environment, supporting security monitoring, endpoint controls and log management
- Contributed to security tool evaluations and proof-of-concept (POC) assessments, providing technical input to support security technology decision-making
- Supported internal security audits, compliance activities and the development of security policies and incident response procedures

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Managed and optimised Microsoft Sentinel across an 8,000-user enterprise environment, onboarding critical log sources, configuring data connectors and building a comprehensive detection rule library aligned to the MITRE ATT&CK framework
- Developed high-fidelity KQL-based detection rules and threat hunting queries within Microsoft Sentinel, materially improving detection coverage across credential theft, lateral movement, persistence and exfiltration threat categories
- Built and refined SOAR-integrated detection playbooks, reducing mean time to respond (MTTR) to security alerts and improving the consistency of incident triage and response
- Led deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) across 8,000 users, extending endpoint monitoring telemetry into the Microsoft Sentinel SIEM for correlated detection
- Implemented CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM as a complementary SIEM platform, expanding log ingestion, threat hunting and detection capability across the hybrid infrastructure

- Provided advisory support for SIEM and security tool evaluations, enabling informed technology decisions aligned to organisational risk and detection requirements

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Salary Expectation: GBP 80,000 - 95,000 | Hybrid (London/UK)